VISUAL NOVEL ENGINE

by Indie Devs

For the most up-to-date docs, follow this link.

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Dependencies

Visual Novel Engine for Unity depends on the Dialogue System for 2D/3D games. If you bought the bundle, then the package already contains the Dialogue System asset. You can find the documentation for the Dialogue System here.

Video Tutorials

Visual Novel Engine for Unity: Quick Start

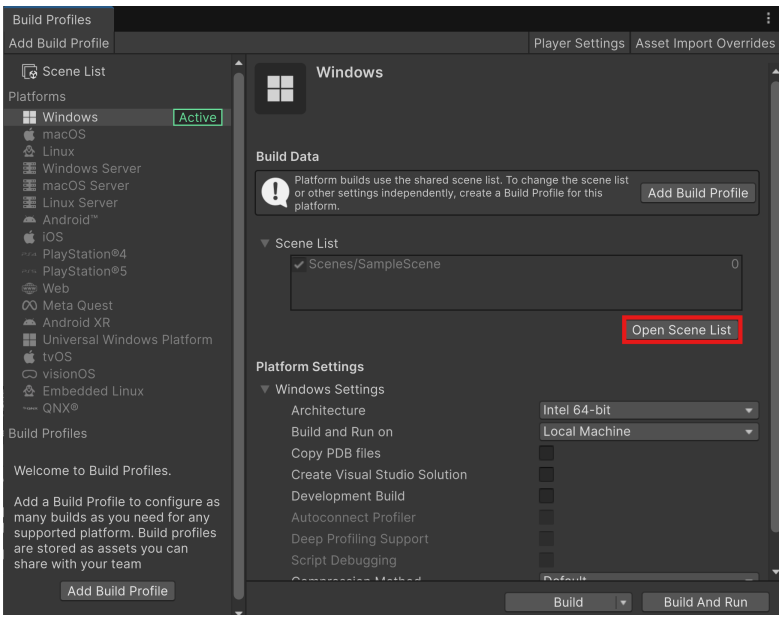
Contact

In case you have some questions, suggestions, or need help getting the asset set up, feel free to contact us at:
Email: jozefgocik03@gmail.com
Discord: https://discord.gg/swadkVj2sY

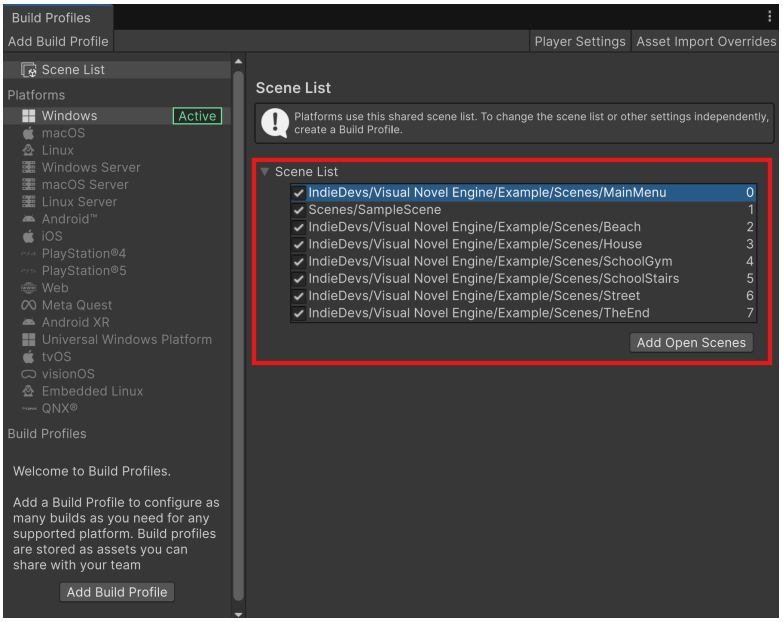
Please rate the asset so Unity recommends it.

Setup

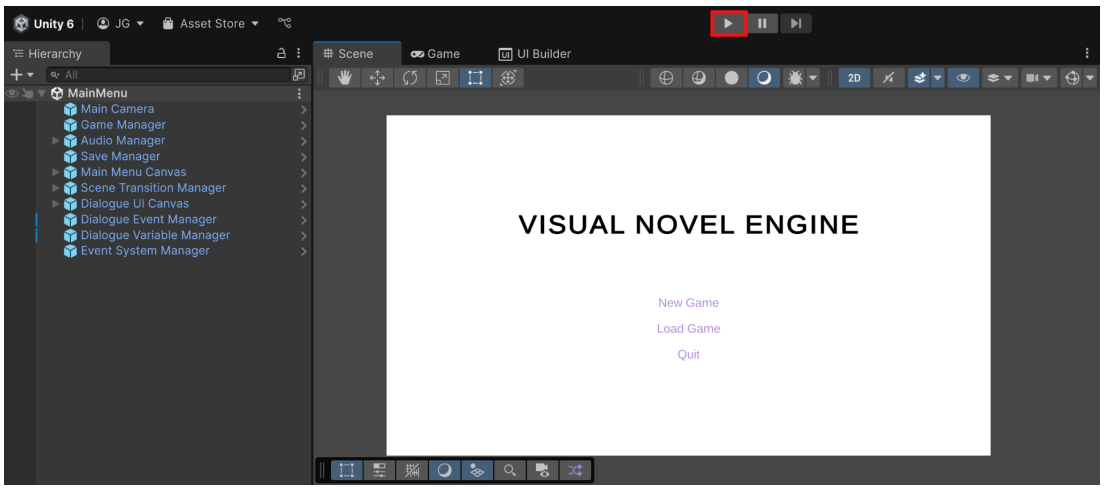
1. Under the Unity menu, navigate to File/Build Profiles and click on the “Open Scene List” button.



2. In the Project tab, navigate to Assets/Indie Devs/Visual Novel Engine/Example/Scenes. Select all of the Scenes and drag and drop them to the Scene List under the Build Profiles tab. Make sure that the MainMenu Scene is at the top.



3. Double-click on the MainMenu scene and hit play to see the pre-made functionality.



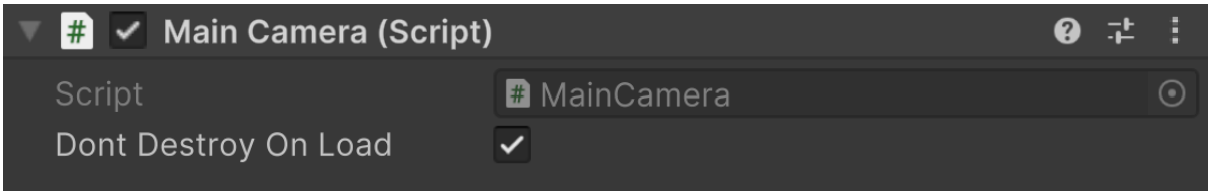
4. Everything under the Example directory was intended to be used as a starting point for your own game. You can move (Ctrl/Cmd + X) all of the folders under the Assets/Indie Devs/Visual Novel Engine/Example folder to the Assets directory and adjust the files directly to match your needs.

Prefabs

Main Camera

Location: Assets/IndieDevs/Visual Novel Engine/Example/Prefabs/Other

The Main Camera prefab includes all of the standard Camera components with an additional script called MainCamera, which inherits from VNEMainCamera. The VNEMainCamera is a singleton MonoBehaviour, ensuring that only one instance of it can exist at any given time.

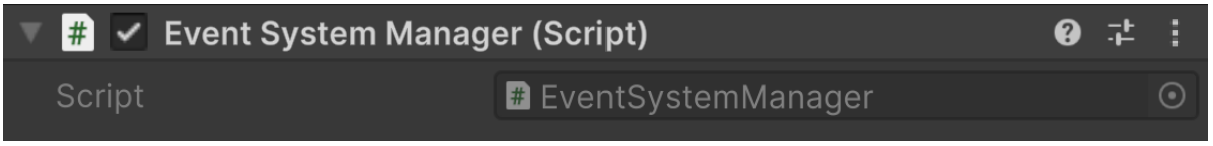


Fields		
Field Name	**Field Type**	**Field Description**
Dont Destroy On Load	bool	When enabled, the GameObject will persist across scene loads. That means the object will not be destroyed when a new scene is loaded, making it available throughout the entire game session.

Event System Manager

Location: Assets/IndieDevs/Visual Novel Engine/Prefabs/Managers

The Event System Manager prefab is responsible for instantiating the EventSystem GameObject and ensuring it persists across all scenes throughout the game session. It is implemented as a singleton, ensuring that only one instance of an EventSystem exists at any given time.



Game Manager

Location: Assets/IndieDevs/Visual Novel Engine/Example/Prefabs/Managers

The Game Manager prefab handles functions and variables that have a global impact on the game. It has a single script attached to it called the GameManager, which inherits from

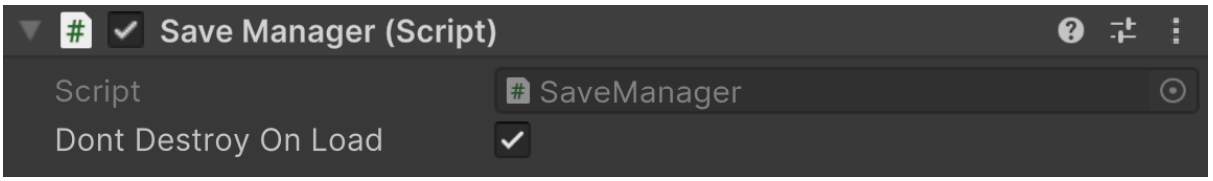
VNEGameManager. The VNEGameManager is a singleton MonoBehaviour, ensuring that only one instance of it exists at any given time.

Fields		
Field Name	**Field Type**	**Field Description**
Dont Destroy On Load	bool	When enabled, the GameObject will persist across scene loads. That means the object will not be destroyed when a new scene is loaded, making it available throughout the entire game session.
Language	enum	Specifies the language to be used for dialogues. The selected language from this field determines which localized text will appear during the game.

Save Manager

Location: Assets/IndieDevs/Visual Novel Engine/Example/Prefabs/Managers

The Save Manager prefab handles the logic for loading and saving the game data. It has a single script attached to it called the SaveManager, which inherits from the VNESaveManager. The VNESaveManager is a singleton MonoBehaviour, ensuring that only one instance of it exists at any given time.



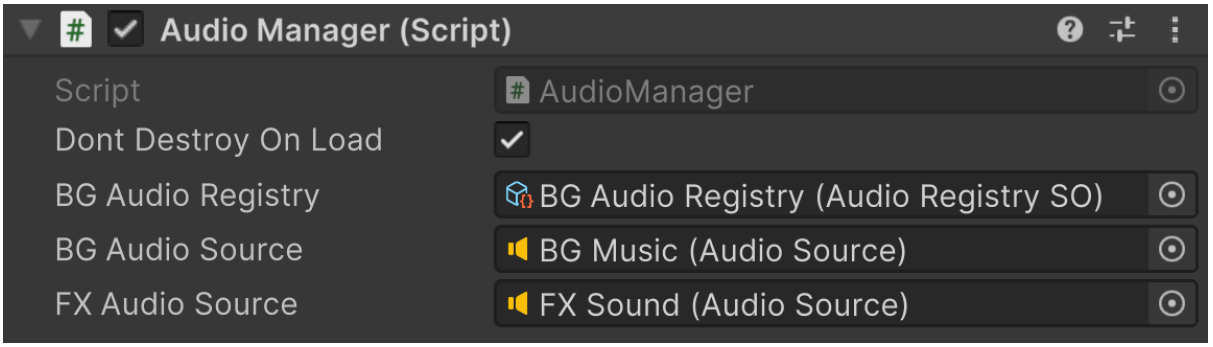
Fields		
Field Name	**Field Type**	**Field Description**
Dont Destroy On Load	bool	When enabled, the GameObject will persist

		across scene loads. That means the object will not be destroyed when a new scene is loaded, making it available throughout the entire game session.

Audio Manager

Location: Assets/IndieDevs/Visual Novel Engine/Example/Prefabs/Managers

The Audio Manager prefab is responsible for managing the audio for both Background music and Sound effects. It has a single script attached to it called the AudioManager, which inherits from the VNEAudioManager. The VNEAudioManager is a singleton MonoBehaviour, ensuring that only one instance of it exists at any given time.

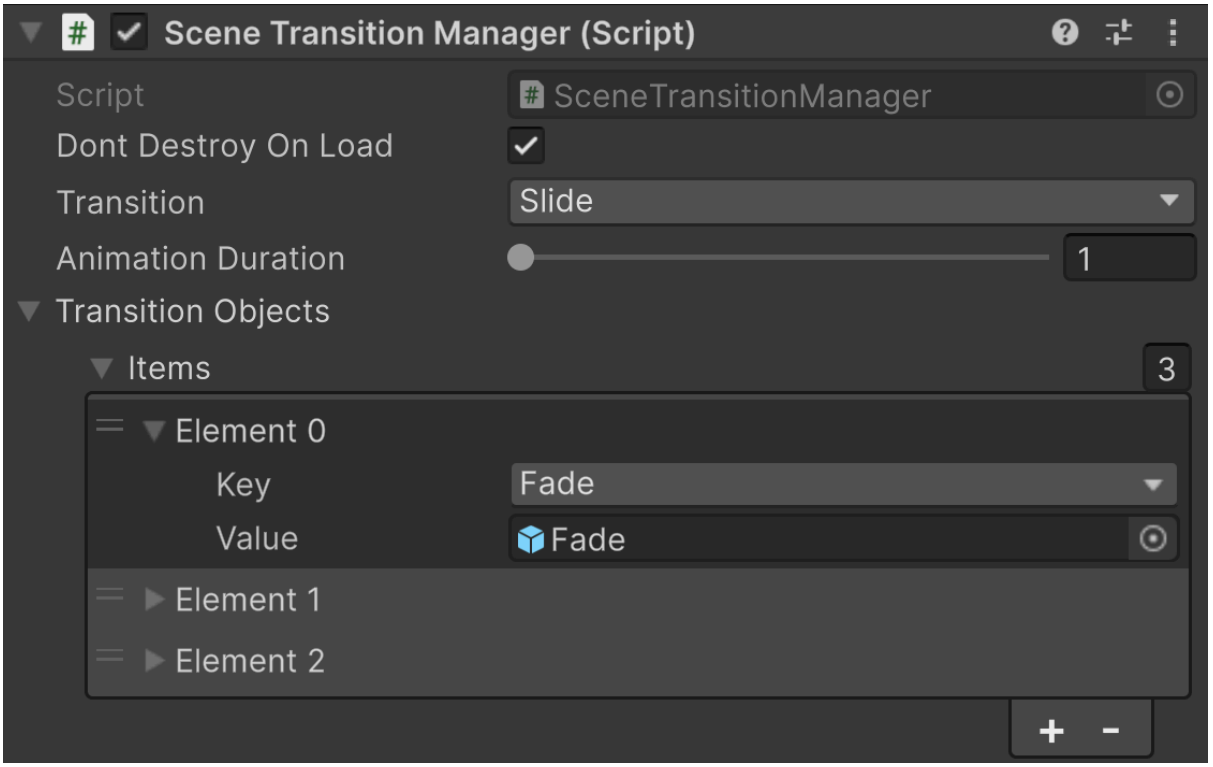


Fields		
Field Name	**Field Type**	**Field Description**
Dont Destroy On Load	bool	When enabled, the GameObject will persist across scene loads. That means the object will not be destroyed when a new scene is loaded, making it available throughout the entire game session.
BG Audio Registry	AudioRegistrySO	This field contains the Audio Registry for all the background music tracks.
BG Audio Source	AudioSource	Reference to the Audio Source responsible for playing the Background music.
FX Audio Source	AudioSource	Reference to the Audio Source responsible for playing the Sound effects.

Scene Transition Manager

Location: Assets/IndieDevs/Visual Novel Engine/Example/Prefabs/Managers

The Scene Transition Manager prefab is responsible for loading scenes and playing the scene transition effects. It has a single script attached to it called the SceneTransitionManager, which inherits from the VNESceneTransitionManager. The VNESceneTransitionManager is a singleton MonoBehaviour, ensuring that only one instance of it exists at any given time.



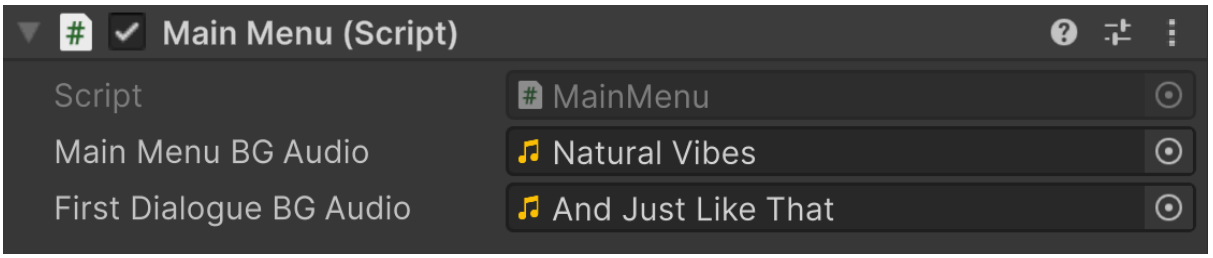
Fields		
Field Name	**Field Type**	**Field Description**
Dont Destroy On Load	bool	When enabled, the GameObject will persist across scene loads. That means the object will not be destroyed when a new scene is loaded, making it available throughout the entire game session.
Transition	enum	Specifies the transition effect that should be played whenever another scene is loaded.
Animation Duration	float	Specifies the duration of the transition effect.

Transition Objects	Dictionary<Transition, GameObject>	Maps Transition to the corresponding GameObject responsible for the specified transition effect.

Main Menu Canvas

Location: Assets/IndieDevs/Visual Novel Engine/Example/Prefabs/UI

The Main Menu Canvas prefab contains several components and child game objects necessary for the main menu to function properly. You can adjust the look of the menu as much as you want. The root GameObject has a MainMenu script attached to it, which is responsible for handling the UI actions.



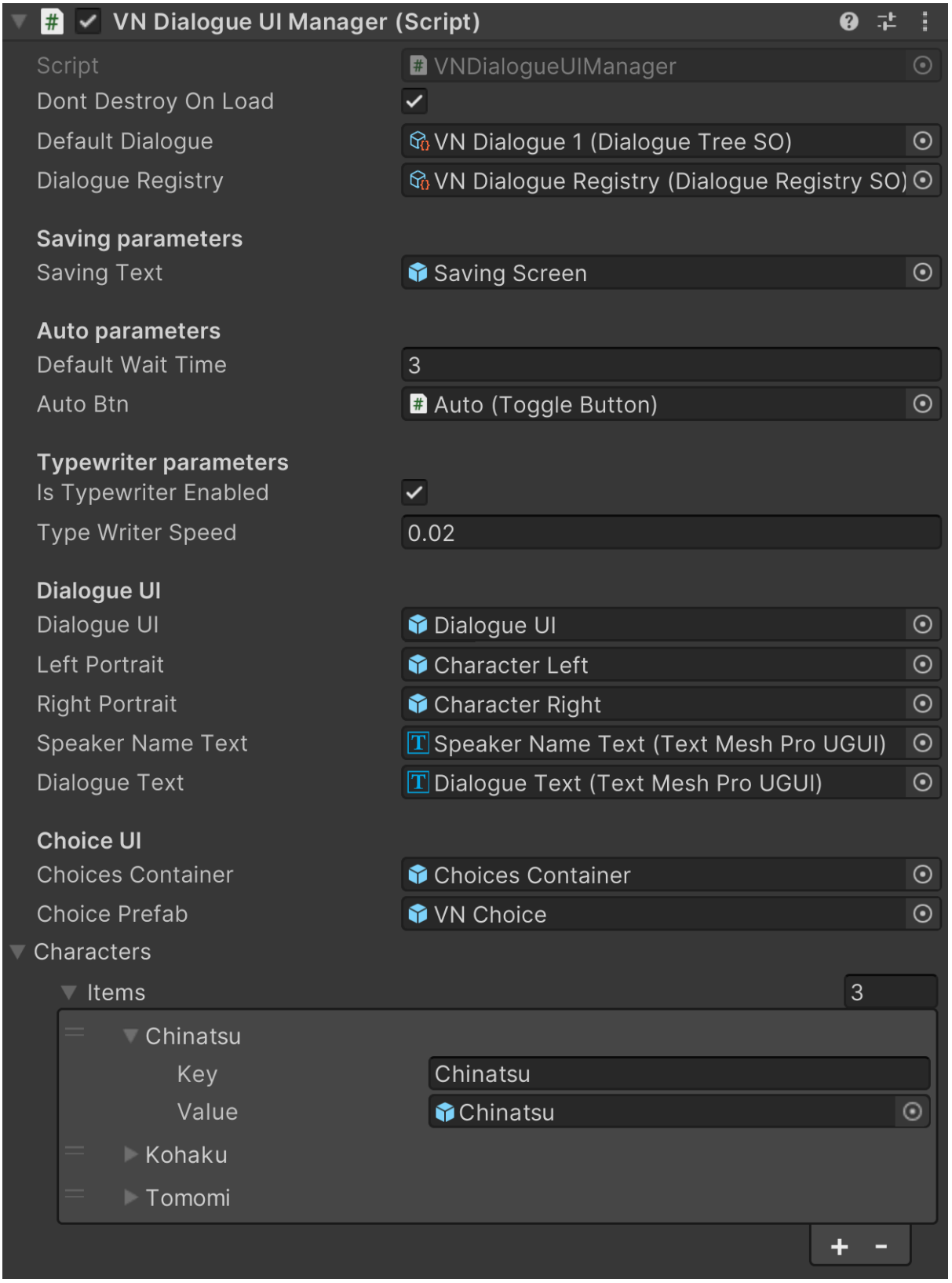
Fields		
Field Name	**Field Type**	**Field Description**
Main Menu BG Audio	AudioClip	The reference to an audio track that will keep playing whenever the MainMenu is the current active scene.
First Dialogue BG Audio	AudioClip	The reference to an audio track that will start playing whenever the user starts a new game and navigates to the very first dialogue.

Dialogue UI Canvas

Location: Assets/IndieDevs/Visual Novel Engine/Example/Prefabs/UI

The Dialogue UI Canvas prefab contains several child game objects and scripts required to manage the dialogue UI logic. The root GameObject has two scripts attached:

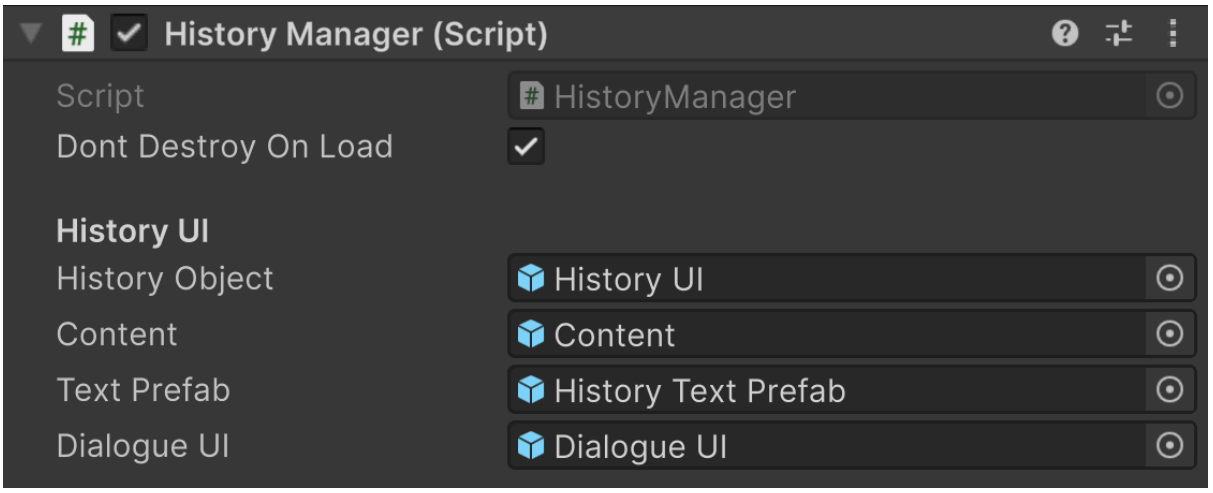
- **VNDialogueUIManager** - Handles all dialogue UI logic, including displaying dialogue, choices, and managing character portraits.
- **HistoryManager** - Manages the saving and display of dialogue history, allowing players to review previously seen dialogues.



Fields		
Field Name	**Field Type**	**Field Description**

Dont Destroy On Load	bool	When enabled, the GameObject will persist across scene loads. That means the object will not be destroyed when a new scene is loaded, making it available throughout the entire game session.
Default Dialogue	DialogueTreeSO	A reference to the very first dialogue.
Dialogue Registry	DialogueRegistrySO	A reference to the DialogueRegistry that contains all of the dialogues used throughout the game.
Saving Text	GameObject	Reference to the “Saving” splash screen.
Default Wait Time	float	Specifies the default number of seconds to wait before automatically advancing to the next dialogue node when Auto mode is enabled.
Auto Btn	ToggleButton	A reference to the UI toggle button that enables or disables automatic dialogue progression.
Is Typewriter Enabled	bool	Specifies if the typewriter effect is on or off.
Typewriter Speed	float	Specifies the speed of the typewriter effect.
Dialogue UI	GameObject	A reference to the Dialogue UI GameObject.
Left Portrait	GameObject	A reference to the GameObject that shows the left portrait.
Right Portrait	GameObject	A reference to the GameObject that shows the right portrait.
Speaker Name Text	TextMeshProUGUI	A reference to a text component that shows the name of the current speaker.
Dialogue Text	TextMeshProUGUI	A reference to the text component that displays the

		current dialogue message on screen.
Choices Container	GameObject	A reference to the GameObject that serves as the parent for all instantiated choice buttons.
Choice Prefab	GameObject (Prefab)	A reference to the prefab used to instantiate individual choice buttons.
Characters	Dictionary<string, GameObject>	A dictionary that maps all of the Character names to their corresponding prefab.



Fields		
Field Name	**Field Type**	**Field Description**
Dont Destroy On Load	bool	When enabled, the GameObject will persist across scene loads. That means the object will not be destroyed when a new scene is loaded, making it available throughout the entire game session.
History Object	GameObject	A reference to the GameObject that holds all of the History UI.
Content	GameObject	A reference to the GameObject that serves as the parent for all instantiated History Text prefabs.

Text Prefab	GameObject (Prefab)	A reference to the prefab used to instantiate individual history text objects.
Dialogue UI	GameObject	A reference to the Dialogue UI GameObject.

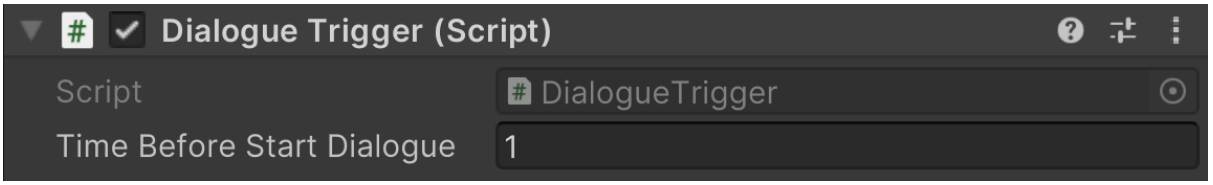
Dialogue Event Manager

The Dialogue Event Manager prefab is part of the Dialogue System asset. You can find more information about the prefab in the Dialogue System asset's documentation.

Dialogue Trigger

Location: Assets/IndieDevs/Visual Novel Engine/Example/Prefabs/Other

The Dialogue Trigger prefab has a single script attached to it called the DialogueTrigger. The DialogueTrigger script starts the dialogue automatically after the scene is loaded.



Fields		
Field Name	**Field Type**	**Field Description**
Time Before Start Dialogue	float	Number of seconds before starting the dialogue after the scene loads.

Scriptable Objects

AudioRegistrySO

The AudioRegistrySO is a ScriptableObject used to store and access multiple AudioClip assets. It serves as a runtime dictionary for fast lookup of AudioClips by name.

To create a new AudioRegistrySO, right-click in Unity's "Project" window and select Create/Visual Novel Engine/Audio Registry.

Public Methods		
Method Name	**Return Type**	**Method Description**
GetAudioClipByName(string id)	AudioClip	Returns an AudioClip with the given name.
ContainsName(string name)	bool	Returns true if the Audio Registry contains an AudioClip with the given name.